

The Quest for Santa Claus

BY

FRANK ATKINSON



PRICE 50 CENTS

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BERWYN, ILL.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE QUEST
FOR SANTA CLAUS ***

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The Quest for Santa Claus

A CHRISTMAS PLAY IN
FOUR ACTS AND A PROLOGUE
DEPICTING FAMILIAR SCENES ON CHRISTMAS EVE
IN MERRY ENGLAND

[Prologue](#)

[Act I](#) A Street in Sandbach

[Act II](#) Brereton Hall

[Act III](#) Room in Santa Claus House

[Act IV](#) Santa Claus Workshop

CAST OF CHARACTERS

ROSALIND, The Original 2 in 1

CAPTAIN OF THE CONGO S. S.

FIRST MATE OF THE CONGO S. S.

MAGGIE }
CRISPIN } A brace of street urchins

MR. S. CLAUS, Toymaker—by special appointment to Her Majesty, the
Queen

MRS. S. CLAUS, Frugal housewife

J. D. ROCKY FELLOW, Lamplighter

WILLIAM KNIGHT HAWK, Watchman

HAROLD }
ETHEL } Two souls with but a single thought

MATTHEW RINGLING, Town Crier

MR. ALLCOCK }
MR. CLEWS } Lovers of darkness rather than light

M'LLE BEATYSAX OPHONIA

M'LLE VIOLA FIDDEL STRINGS

M'LLE SKYLARK LINNETTE NIGHTENGAL

MONSIEUR WOOD WYNDE

M'LLE FLUFFY

M'LLE TABITHA, Playful as a Kitten

SANTA CLAUS, Fountain of Eternal Youth

LUCIFER MATCH, King of Imps

Citizens, Waits, Retinue of Imps

NOTE: Before the curtain rises upon Act I, as soon as the company has assembled, the Superintendent ostensibly begins a short address of welcome. While thus engaged, "Beggar Maid" enters at the rear of the room and immediately starts in with her lines and by the time the First Mate, who up until that point has been serving as an Usher, has made reply the whole audience is conscious of the conversation taking place, and the dialogue goes on uninterrupted until the end.

The transformation accomplished by the erstwhile Beggar Maid, but now a Fairy Princess, is the sudden illumination of the evergreen trees flanking both sides of the stage by colored electric lights, and is very effective.

PROLOGUE

BEGGAR MAID: Please, sir, and wot's a'goin' on 'ere, is it the movies or somethin'?

(USHER) First Mate: No, this is a Christmas Party for the boys and girls of the Sunday School.

BEGGAR MAID: Oh, I'm sorry—not for them, but for myself—I thought, if it was a movie you might let me in for this ha'penny—it's all the money I've got—But this is no place for me—nobody wants a beggar around when they're 'avin' parties.

(Beggar Maid turns to leave, but before doing so the usher takes her by the hand.)

(USHER) First Mate: No, don't go away—I assure you we shall be glad to have you as our guest—Come with me.

BEGGAR MAID: No, thank 'ee, I can't come here wi' on'y these rags.

(As she speaks she is struggling to get away.)

(SUPT.) Captain (Addressing the Usher): What is it, Mr. ——?

(USHER) First Mate: We have with us, Mr. Superintendent, an unexpected guest—a stranger in town, who came here thinking it was a movie show—I've been telling our young friend that she will be welcome—but she is reluctant to accept my invitation.

(SUPT.) Captain: You are quite right, Mr. ——, we are indeed happy to have anyone come and share our joy—let me assure you, dear, you are welcome—come right along, see here we have a vacant chair where you will be able to see the players, and, I dare say, you will find them quite as fine as any you would see at the movies.

(By this time, with reluctant steps, led by the (USHER) First Mate, the Beggar Maid has come to the front of the room and the center of the stage.)

(But instead of taking the proffered seat, turning to the (Superintendent) Captain, and rising to her full stature, she

speaks.)

BEGGAR MAID: Mr. Superintendent, I am much pleased to find here the Spirit of the Master, and to vouchsafe to you and to all of these dear people gathered here, a royal, happy good time in all your merrymaking, and in the homage I trust each and all are now bringing in honor of the infant Christ, who, two thousand years ago was born in a lowly stable amid the hills of Bethlehem, in old Judea. No less true is it in our day than it was of old that oftentimes we entertain angels unaware. Doubtless, you think I am only a beggar, and for that I am very thankful, for thus it is possible for me to reward the kindly spirit you have shown to those less fortunate than yourselves. But you see I am not a beggar.

(Here the Beggar Maid drops off her outer garment.) but a fairy princess, whose magic wand can make beauty spring up everywhere.

(Turning to the right hand she waves her wand over the trees, which instantly flash into beauty, (colored lights), and then to the left hand—and, while the people are rejoicing over the illumination, she rapidly runs down the center aisle to rear of room, and makes her escape, stopping only once to wish them

“A Merry Christmas.”)

END OF PROLOGUE

ACT I.

STREET IN SANDBACH

NOTE: When the curtain rises Santa Claus is busy arranging toys in shop window, lighting candles and doing such other stage work as will enliven the scene.

No lines are spoken until Crispin and Maggie come upon the scene, the idea being to portray the various types of folk one would expect to find upon the street—the types can be many or few, fishmongers, washwomen, laborers, children, musicians, teamsters returning from work, street arabs, etc. Some of these enter the shop and buy, others, like Crispin and Maggie, must be content with looking in. These characters should enter alternately from right and left stage.

(Enter Crispin.) Note: Boy enters right stage.

(Enter Maggie. After one-half minute girl follows, enters left stage. They both walk slowly up stage to window of the toy shop, keeping as far apart as is possible. Both are interested only in the window display, and for some time neither of them speak.)

MAGGIE: Hello!

CRISPIN: (After pause) 'lo!

(Another silence)

MAGGIE: D'jer live 'ere?

CRISPIN: Naw.

MAGGIE: Neither do I. (Pause). Wot's yer name?

CRISPIN: Der gang calls me Cris, but in 'igh sasiety dey calls me Crispin.

(After pause)

Wot's yore name?

MAGGIE: W'en I call on the queen my name is Maggie, but the folk in our alley call me Mag.

CRISPIN: Wot yer hidin' under yer apron?

MAGGIE: A apple.

CRISPIN: We're d'jer swipe it?

MAGGIE: I didn't swipe it, smarty, an old guv'ner gave it to me for running an errand for 'im.

CRISPIN: Is that all 'e guv yer?

MAGGIE: Isn't that enough—wot yer want a guy to guv yer—a sixpence fer doin' nuthin'—an' besides, he wor a nice ol' gentleman.

CRISPIN: How d'jer know—was 'e a friend of yer feyther?

MAGGIE: Naw, smarty, 'e was no friend of my fambly, I never seen 'im before tonight—but I know 'e is a nice man—he said such nice things to me.

CRISPIN: Wot d'jer mean by nice things—I never seed any on 'em knockin' around our alley.

MAGGIE: Well—w'en I got back to 'im he smiled and said, "Thank yer, mi dear, and 'eres a apple fer yer, and I wish yer a Merry Christmas."

CRISPIN: (H)excuse me, Mag, fer takin' liberties with yer name on such a short acquaintance, but I 'ave to laff w'en I 'ear of these rich guys wishin' the likes of us a 'appy Christmas, and doin' nuthin' to 'elp make their wish come true.—Now if yer kind benefactor 'ad said, "Here's a ten-pound note—go and get yerself some warm clothes to cover yer 'arf-naked body, and some food to fill yer empty stomach, and get fer yerself one o' them golden-'aired dollys wot shut their eyes, and say, 'Mamma' when yer punch 'em in their breadbasket," I could feel he were sincere in his good wishes for yer.

MAGGIE: Now, Cris, yer mustn't run on like that, it isn't fair—some of these rich folk never had the chances you and me 'ave 'ad—and so I say, clothes, or no clothes, food, or no food, blue-eyed sleepin', squawkin' dollies, or no dollies, I'm glad fer the progress some on 'em 'ave made. Perhaps some day they will learn that true Christmas 'appiness *begins in well wishing and ends in well doing*. Until then we must be content in *lookin'* at the things which belong

to others, just as we 'ave been doin' before this winder fer the last 'arf 'our.

(At this point the clock in the steeple strikes five.)

CRISPIN: Gee, I must be going.

MAGGIE: So must I, Cris—but before we part I want to wish yer a Merry Christmas.

(Both start to walk away in opposite directions, but before leaving the stage Maggie stops.)

MAGGIE: Say, Cris, just a minute—'ave yer a jack knife in yer pocket?

(Cris searches his pockets—fishes out a rather dilapidated knife—opens it, and hands it to Maggie, who cuts apple in half—returns knife to Cris.)

MAGGIE: And ter make my wish come true, Cris—'er's the 'alf of my apple.

(Both leave the stage, joyfully eating the apple and grinning from ear to ear.)

(Exit Maggie, Right.)

(Exit Crispin, Left.)

(Lamplighter. Enter right, lights street lamp and exit left.)

(Washerwoman. Enter left, carrying basket of wash.)

(Fishmonger. Enter right—Fresh herrin', all alive, all alive, all alive. Herrin', fresh herrin', twelve fer a shillin'. Note: As she passes the shop of Santa Claus, Mrs. Claus opens shop door.)

MRS. CLAUS: Are you sure yer herrin' are fresh?

FISHMONGER: Mi lady, so 'elp me, they were swimmin' in the sea this very mornin'.

MRS. CLAUS: Wot are yer askin' fer 'em?

FISHMONGER: O'ny a shillin' a dozen, lady.

MRS. CLAUS: That's wot I call dear for herrin'. Make it nine-pence and I'll take a dozen.

FISHMONGER: No, ma'am, not if I never sell 'em (walks away.) Fresh herrin', herrin', herrin', all alive, all alive, (suddenly turns again.) Well, missus, seeing as I on'y have a few left, 'ere yer are, tak 'em at yer own price. Counts out herring and exit.

(At this point Santa Claus locks up his shop for the night, puts up shutters in front of windows and returns into shop.)

(Musician. Enter right, carrying bass viol.)

(Night Watchman: Enter left, eight o'clock and all's well. Exit right. Note by this time the village streets are nearly deserted.)

(Enter Ethel. Enter Harold. Immediately following exit of Watchman after his 8 o'clock round, Harold and Ethel enter from left stage—Harold is leading Ethel by the hand. They look around from one side of the street to the other, which at this time is deserted.)

ETHEL: I don't believe Santa lives here.

HAROLD: Neither do I—I expect he lives in a big house, like the Earl of Crewe.

ETHEL: I am beginning to think we shall not find Santa at all.

HAROLD: Oh, yes, sis, we will find him—don't get discouraged.

ETHEL: But you are forgetting it is nearly time for him to start out on his long journey.

HAROLD: I have not forgotten that, but I am thinking that it takes a big factory to hold all the toys Santa has made since last year.

ETHEL: Yes, but I don't see any big factory here, do you?

HAROLD: Look! Look! Ethel, I believe we have found it—see that sign over the shop window, it says S. CLAUS, TOYMAKER.

ETHEL: Yes, and the shutters are up—that's because Santa doesn't want anyone to see him at work.

HAROLD: Let us go and knock on the door and see if Santa will answer.

ETHEL: No, I am a little bit afraid. You go.

(While the children are hesitating about what ought to be done, Mr. S. Claus leaves the place and starts to walk away rapidly. Just then, the children turn and catch sight of him.)

HAROLD: See, Ethel, there he goes—Come, let us follow him.

(Both children leave the stage, shouting, “Santa, Santa, wait a minute, please, Santa, wait.”)

(Exit Harold and Ethel.)

(Enter Towncrier from right stage.)

(First time off stage—Second time on stage—Crier takes center stage, rings bell vigorously, takes position with bell reposing in left arm, with right hand clutching tongue of bell.)

TOWN CRIER: Lost, strayed or stolen, a ten-year-old boy and his young sister—the children of our fellow townsman, Mr. Alphonso Cruickshank, Ironmonger and Tinker, of Number 12, High Street, Sandbach. When last seen, the children were walking in the direction of Congleton Road, but beyond this their whereabouts are unknown. A reward of 50 guineas in gold will be paid to any person, or persons, who, finding the children, shall safely return them to their bereaved parents.

(Exit Crier.)

(Watchman in distance is heard calling, “Nine o’clock and all’s well.” The village clock strikes the hour and the chimes sweetly play.)

(Enter Clews, right, who saunters across stage and returns, taking position under lamp, when chimes are ended.)

(Enter Allcock, left, carrying bundle.)

CLEWS: Good evenin’, mate, w’ere ’as thi bin, I’ve been waitin’ on thi fur the last ’our.

ALLCOCK: I dunna wonder at thi askin’ w’ere I’ve been. This’ll be the first toime in the last twel’ yer that I’ve missed bein’ at the Black Bear on Christmas eve. But that is ner the on’y thing I’ve missed, so I must ’asten ’ome and get a bite o’ summat to eat.

CLEWS: Does ta mean to tell me thi 'asn't 'ad thi supper yet?

ALLCOCK: I conna speak no plainer than w'at I sed a minit ago.

CLEWS: But w'at kept thi away from 'ome so long—Surely not the love of thi work?

ALLCOCK: No, 'ardly that, but thi knows 'ow it is hup at the 'all—an' 'ow they fixes hup everythin' fur the big party they're 'avin come ter-morrer—I dunno wat they would a dun if I'd a quit on 'em.

CLEWS: I 'no wat thi means, mate, I've thought miself wot a 'elpless lot some folk are.

ALLCOCK: Aye, all I 'eard ter-day was, “Willyum, 'ave yer killed an' dressed the sucking pigs—Willyum, 'ave yer finished plucking the geese—Willyum, will yer be sure there are yule logs on 'and fer the party—Willyum, go down to the butchers and bring the roast of beef I ordered—William, this, and Willyum that,” until I'm sick and tired o' mi own name.

But they're not a bad lot at that for the mester gave me a Christmas box o' ten shilling' an' I 'ave in this bundle some clothes wot belonged to the little gel w'at died a year ago come Michaelmas, an' a bran new dress w'ich the missus sent to mi owd woman.

CLEWS: Mite it be yer 'ad a goose in yer bundle fer yer Christmas dinner, as well as the fine feathers fer the missus?

ALLCOCK: No, Jack, but you 'no and I 'no w'ere there is as fine a dinner waitin' fer them as knows, as ever come out o' a pot—and yer 'ave 'eard tell as 'ow the first thing to be dun in makin' rabbit pie is to first catch the rabbit.

CLEWS: I understand, Willyum—Make it ten by the clock—at the old place back of the 'all.

ALLCOCK: So long, mate.

CLEWS: So long.

(Exit Poachers.)

(Enter Carolers.)

1. What Child is This?
2. Good King Wenceslas.
3. Christians Awake, Salute the Happy Morn.

(Exit Carolers.)

CURTAIN

NOTE: It is very effective when the carolers can conveniently sing for the first time off stage, as if in the distance. The carolers should be appropriately dressed for cold weather, carry lanterns and the stage should be darkened.

ACT II.

NOTE: Harold and Ethel in their pursuit of Santa Claus, the village Toymaker and Shop Keeper, find themselves far from home and in the grounds immediately surrounding Brereton Hall. The stage setting should consist of a hedge row built up of small evergreen trees at the rear of the stage and on both ends, with a wooden stile set in the hedge on right stage. Evergreen branches are strewn around, left there by the hedger, who had been trimming the hedges about the grounds.

The children enter from left and the Poachers, for such are Clews and Allcock, who later appear, enter from the right, climb over the stile and soon get busy at the task which brought them there, namely, the bagging of a brace of rabbits for their Christmas dinner.

(As the curtain rises, Harold and Ethel are wearily dragging themselves across stage—when center is reached, Ethel stops, and in tears she refuses to go any further.)

ETHEL (tearfully): Harold, I just can't go another step, I want to go home to mamma.

HAROLD: Don't cry, Sis, you know I believe we're almost there—if you only think of the fun we will have when we find Santa, you will forget all about being tired.

ETHEL: I know it will be lots of fun to see Santa, and, if we ever do find him, I'm going to ask him to show me all his wonderful toys. But I think I'd rather wait until next year. I want mamma.

(No longer able to restrain herself, she bursts out crying, much to the undoing of Harold.)

HAROLD: See here, Sis, please don't cry. When we get home I'll give you my new cricket bat and ball. Perhaps if we sit down for a little while we will get rested. I'll just gather a few of these branches—that will be better than sitting on the cold ground.

(Harold arranges the branches as a little bed down stage, and places Ethel upon it.)

ETHEL: How lonely it is here at night. Can you see any houses near?

HAROLD: (Climbing up on stile so as to look over the hedge):

Yes, I see a big house not far away. I'm sure that must be where Santa is. Let us rest here awhile.

(Harold seats himself beside Ethel—puts his arms around her, draws her near to him.)

And then we will surely find Santa.

(After pause)

I'm jolly glad the moon is shining, aren't you, Ethel?

(Ethel does not answer, for she has fallen asleep. Gently Harold lays her down upon the boughs and with a yawn says——)

I think I'll just rest awhile myself.

(And in a minute he, too, is fast asleep.)

(Soon after the children fall asleep, two Poachers arrive on the scene, and, entirely oblivious to the fact that there are human beings near them, they proceed to the work of the evening, just as the bell in the village clock strikes the hour of ten. All through the work of the Poachers the children remain fast asleep.)

(Just as the Poachers make ready to leave, the children are discovered.)

CLEWS: Well. I'll be blow'ed, if 'ere aint the babes in the wood.

ALLCOCK (rushing to cover): Wo't, yer don't mean the Game-keeper and his gang? W'y don't yer duck?

CLEWS: (laughing heartily): 'Oo said onythin' about game-keepers. Come an' luk fer thy sel'—'ere are two as fine babbys as yer hever sot h'eyes on.

ALLCOCK (drawing near to sleeping children): Blime me, if they haint. I wonder wot they're doin' 'ere at this time o' noight?

CLEWS: I conna tell thi that, mon, w'y doesn't thi ask 'em thi sel'?

ALLCOCK (gently shaking Harold): Wake h'up, little mon, does ta want to catch thi death o' cold lying out 'ere this cold night—and what about the little gel, wake 'er h'up tew.

(After some time and much rubbing of eyes, the children awaken.)

HAROLD: Please, Mr., can you tell us who lives in yonder house—Sis and I hope that is where Santa lives. If so, we must be going, or else Santa will have left.

ETHEL: Yes, you know he will go just as soon as the clock strikes twelve, and we want to see his wonderful toys before he leaves.

CLEWS: 'Earken to that, will yer, these kids want to see Santa Claus—Ha! Ha! Ha! Say, Kiddie, there haint no Santa.

HAROLD: You are mistaken, sir, for sis and I saw him tonight, with our own eyes, but he walked so fast we couldn't catch up to him.

ALLCOCK: An' w'ere might it be that yer saw the idol of yer dreams?

HAROLD: We saw him come from his shop in the square near the Black Bear.

CLEWS (aside): Say, mate, it's the owd codger, S. Claus, the kiddies are thinkin' on. Wot der yer say if we giv 'em a lift. It's not much the likes of uz can do to make anny body 'appy, but 'eres a little job we con do as well as anny on 'em.

ALLCOCK: Yer rite, mate.

(Turning to children)

Come along, we'll 'ave yer in front of 'is r'yal 'ighness in less nor a jiff'ey.

(Exit Poachers with the now happy children upon their shoulders, and their Christmas dinner safely bagged.)

(Enter King of the Imps—At blast of whistle the imps spring up behind the hedge.)

IMPS (all): What ho, your majesty!

LUCIFER MATCH: Assemble ye here for a council of war.

IMPS (all): Your Majesty's commands shall be obeyed.

(Imps gather down stage and seat themselves Indian fashion in a circle—the King remains standing.)

LUCIFER MATCH (addressing Imps): My mind is ill at ease—Go where I will, I fail not to observe how men, in city, town, and hamlet throughout the land, in fealty to Him they call the Christ, are moved to deeds of mercy and of love.

IMP NO. 1: If such be true, Your Majesty, it bodes ill of thee and thy kingdom of darkness.

LUCIFER MATCH: Yea, such is true, and not content with that, they move from street to street, and house to house, and, like the angels on Bethlehem hills, two thousand years ago, they proclaim the Messiah's birth, and sing of *Peace and Goodwill to Men*. Thus do they assail and threaten my right to reign and rule.

IMP NO. 1: It must not be, Your Majesty.

LUCIFER MATCH: It shall not be—some way must be found to stop these inroads upon my kingdom and domain—but what to do, and how, and when, I know not.

IMP NO. 1: Has not Your Majesty thought of persecution?

LUCIFER MATCH: Persecution, in that ye counsel without knowledge. To stop this tide of Christmas cheer by persecution is as foolish as to attempt to dam a river at its mouth.

IMP NO. 1: Has not Your Majesty discovered any arch conspirator in this plot?

LUCIFER MATCH: Aye, that I have and by cunning ways have I sought to turn him from his course, but neither threat, money, or persuasion have any effect upon him to check the rising of good will, which, like water gushing from a fountain, overflows and fills the hearts of the children of men everywhere with his own genial spirit and warm friendliness.

IMP NO. 1: Where does he abide, Your Majesty?

LUCIFER MATCH: He lives hard by an Inn, the Black Bear, where incessantly he toils throughout the year in fashioning toys and other gifts, which he lavishly bestows upon the people in his journey around the world on Christmas night—but I fear his real abode is in the hearts of men, and particularly in the hearts of little children.

IMP NO. 1 (rising and bowing): Pardon me, Sire for venturing to suggest that thou commission us to wreak destruction upon the toys, or otherwise prevent this arch enemy of thine from carrying out his plan.

LUCIFER MATCH: Thou speakest words of wisdom, and it is my will that thou perform in my name, and in behalf of my kingdom this work of destruction. Here, then, is thy commission—Look well to the task.

(King hands document to Imp No. 1, who reads it aloud to the other Imps.)

“Whereas, one Santa Claus, by cunning devices and by his unfailing good humor and goodwill, is stealing the hearts and fealty of my hitherto loyal subjects—now, therefore, do I, Lucifer Match, declare that from this hour I will give him no peace or rest—

And, in order that his work may be brought to nought, I do commission my loyal band of Imps to sally forth and utterly destroy not only this arch conspirator, but all his handiwork—To him who shall accomplish the downfall of this personification of Christmas Peace and Good Will, I give the half of my kingdom, and the hand of my daughter in marriage.

LARGE
RED
SEAL

(Signed) LUCIFER MATCH,
King of the Imps.”

(After reading of commission, exit Lucifer Match. *Then Imps disappear behind the hedge.*)

END OF ACT II. CURTAIN.

ACT III.

SCENE—ROOM IN SANTA CLAUS' HOUSE

(When the curtain rises, Santa is doing some simple task around the room with his back to the audience—then, turning around as the clock strikes eleven, he speaks—)

SANTA: Ah, the time is drawing nigh when I must sally forth—An hour yet remains, and so I'll improve it by taking a little nap—How good it is after the day's toil is ended to sweetly rest—perchance to dream of the fruit of one's labor. Here's a cushion for my head, and what matters if my feet hang o'er the end like culprits from the gallows. 'Tis good—And now to sleep——

(Santa sinks into deep slumber.)

(Enter Imps stealthily—3 from right, and 3 from left—They look around the room and presently discover Santa. They look first toward Santa's picture on the wall and then at Santa.)

IMP 5: This is the place.

IMP 2 (pointing to Santa): And there's the man.

IMP 3: Methinks already half of my lord's kingdom is mine.

IMP 4: Strike then the blow.

IMP 3 (approaches Santa, then returns): My heart fails me—Strike thou the blow.

IMP 5 (approaches Santa, then returns): Only a traitor could strike so kindly a face as his.

IMP 1: Cowards, make way—I'll lay him low.

(Advances to Santa with hand uplifted as if to strike.)

His must be a charmed life—I can no ill do unto him.

(Turning to Imps)

Is there no one willing to obey our king?

IMPS (all): No, not one—Would that our king were Santa—and here and now we pledge to him our allegiance.

(Each approaches Santa in turn making a profound bow, and then leaves the room—excepting Imp 1.)

SANTA CLAUS' ROOM

IMP 1: I know what power is this which makes me traitor to my king—Would I could warn him of his danger.

(Walks to and fro in deep thought.)

This will I do—With my dagger will I pinion to yon wall this commission of my king, so shall he learn of the king's purpose to do him harm.

(Walks to back of stage—takes dagger from belt, and thrusts it through the Royal Commission to the wall.)

(Then, after making bow to Santa, he retires off stage.)

(Exit Imp No. 1. After exit of Imp No. 1, Santa awakens, stretches, and after rising makes discovery of the Imp's Commission, which he removes from the wall, examines dagger, reads commission, laughs heartily, and to show his disdain tears commission to bits.)

(A loud knock upon the door announces the arrival of Harold and Ethel whom the poachers have safely landed at the home of Santa Claus. Santa goes to door, left stage, and there finds the two children whom he invites to enter.)

SANTA: Well! Well! Well! In all my life I have never before had the pleasure of a visit in my home from two such interesting children. But what brought you here at this time of night?

HAROLD: We came on the shoulders of two of the nicest men we ever met, didn't we, Ethel?

ETHEL: Yes, and I am afraid we should never have found you, Santa, if they hadn't helped us.

SANTA: Now, that you have found me what is it you want?

HAROLD: Sis wants awfully to see your wonderful toys, but I believe I'd like a nice soft bed to sleep in. (Yawns.) I'm so tired.

ETHEL: You mustn't mind what Harold says, Santa; of course, we both want to see the toys, even though we are tired. (Ethel yawns.) You see, Santa, we have been searching everywhere for you.

SANTA: This is perplexing, but I think I am beginning to understand. Let us go into the next room. Mrs. Santa will know what to do for tired and hungry children, and then I will show you a few of my animated toys which I assure you is a rare privilege. Come along.

(Santa takes them by the hand.)

(Exit right.)

CURTAIN.

ACT IV.

SANTA'S WORKSHOP

When the curtain rises, the toys are standing rigidly at back of stage. Santa enters with children, whom he seats back to audience at front and center of stage. Santa then proceeds to exhibit the toys, winding them up, marching them to front stage, then to position at front of stage right and left.

M'lle Beatysax Ophonia, Saxophone Solo

M'lle Viola Fiddel Strings, Violin Solo

M'lle Skylark Linnette Nightengale, Vocal Solo

Monsieur Wood Wynde, Flute Solo

M'lle Tabitha, Playful as a Kitten, who makes merriment whenever the dolls are not actually doing their stunt.

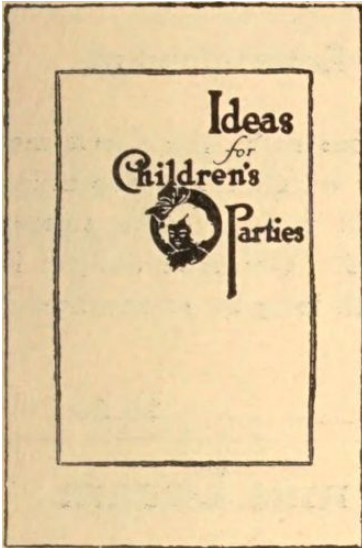
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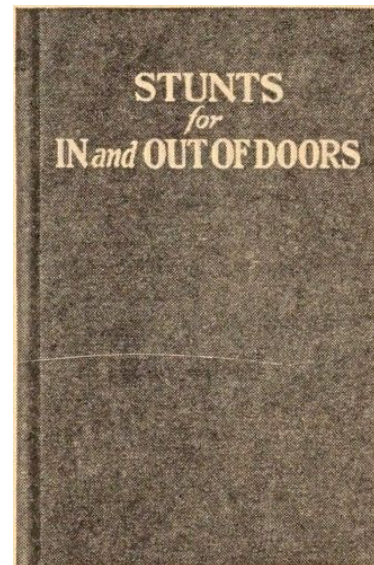
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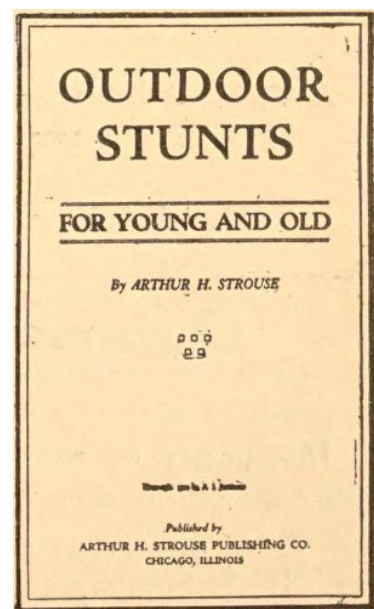


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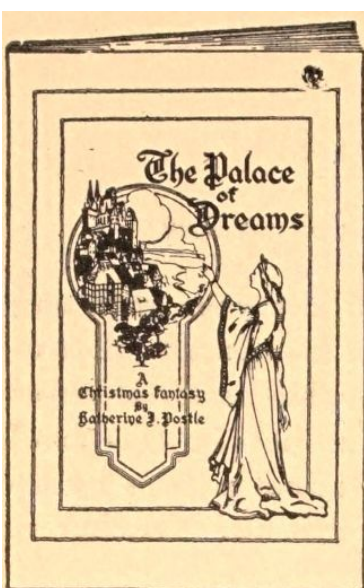
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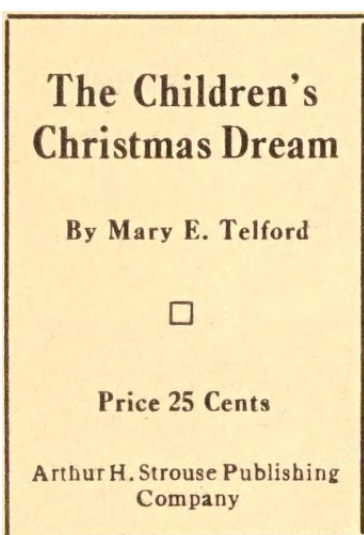


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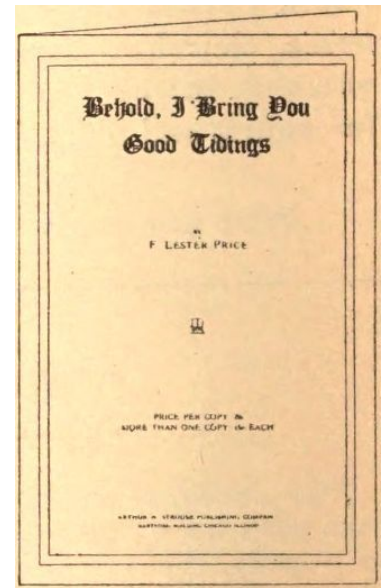
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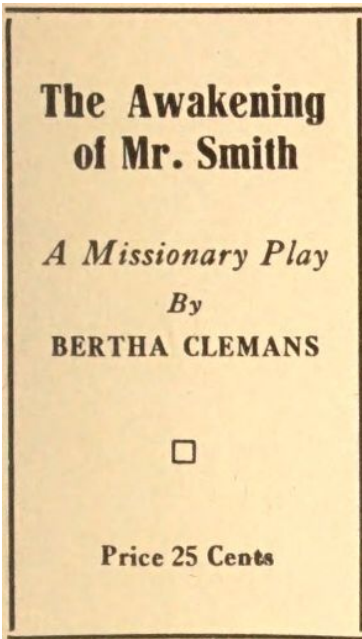


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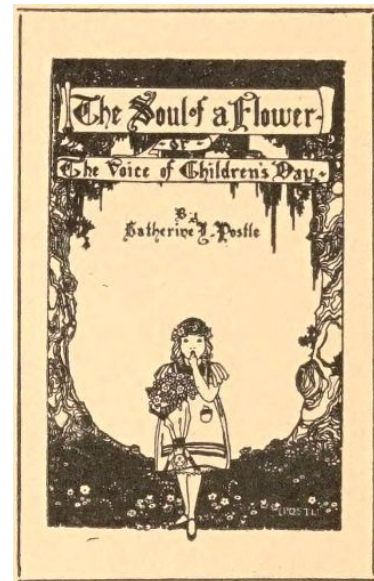
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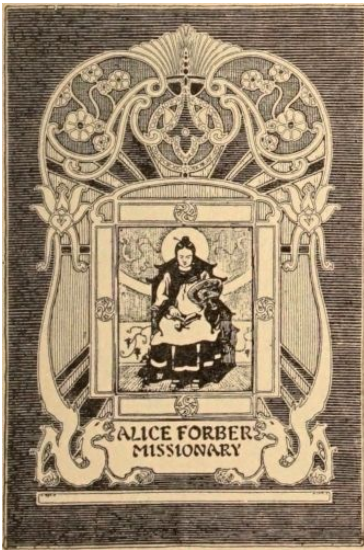
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[page 6](#): "this very morning" changed to "this very mornin"

[page 6](#): "Musician" line turned to stage directions

[page 8](#): "Enter Carolers." line turned to stage directions

[page 9](#): "Dont' cry" changed to "Don't cry"

[page 9](#): "she burst out" changed to "she bursts out"

[page 11](#): "kindgdom of darkness" changed to "kingdom of darkness"

[page 15](#): "they hadnt' helped" changed to "they hadn't helped"

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